ACCENTURE 2026–2027 HIRING · COGNITIVE ASSESSMENT · GAME 2

Pathfinding Game
Zero to Hero Guide

Guide the rocket to the planet by rotating and swapping tiles. Learn how the screen works, the tracing method top scorers use, rotation logic, a full illustrated play-through and 12 practice puzzles with verified answers.

- Screen explained
- Rotate · Swap · Check
- Illustrated play-through
- Tracing method
- 12 practice puzzles

3	~4–5	1–3	Likely
Puzzles	Minutes each	Tile changes usually needed	Elimination round

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How to use this guide

- **Never seen this game?** Read Sections 1–5. Section 5 plays a full puzzle with pictures at every step.
- **Know the game but make mistakes?** Focus on Sections 6–8: the tracing method and the "earliest wrong tile" rule.
- **Ready to practise?** Do the 12 puzzles in Section 10 and check your answers in Section 11.

THE BIG PICTURE

01 Game 2 at a Glance

Pathfinding is the **second game** in the Cognitive (Gamified) Assessment. A **rocket** must travel through a grid of **track tiles** to reach a **planet**. The track is broken in a few places. Your job is to **repair the route** by rotating and swapping tiles, then press **Check**.

PUZZLES	TIME	SKILL	ELIMINATION
3	~4–5 min each	Spatial logic	Likely

Speed vs patience

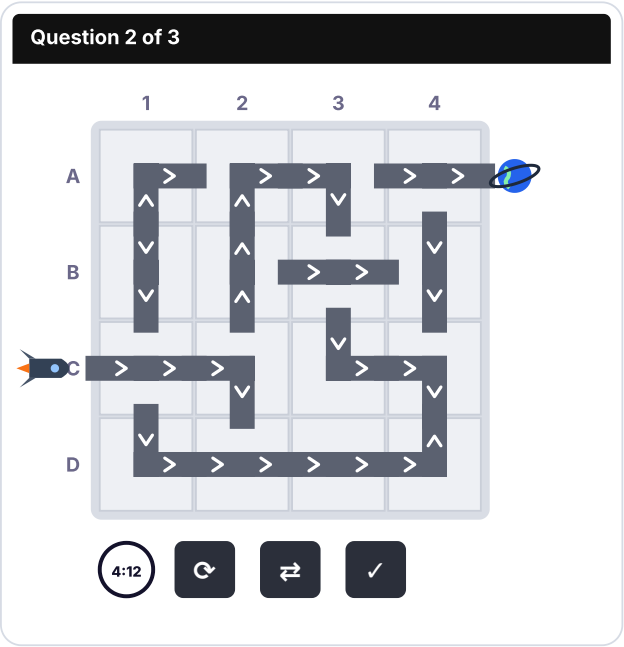
Unlike the Bubbles game (15 seconds per question), here you get several minutes per puzzle. That means **careful, systematic tracing beats speed**. Most puzzles need only **1–3 tile changes**. The challenge is finding the right ones.

02

KNOW THE SCREEN

The Screen Explained

This illustration is drawn from candidate screenshots. The real grid may be bigger (around 5×5 or more), but every element works the same way.



1. **Question counter** (top): which of the 3 puzzles you're on.
2. **Rocket** (left edge): the **start**. It enters the grid at this point.
3. **Planet** (right edge): the **destination**. The route must end here.
4. **Track tiles:** each square holds a track piece. The small white arrows show the direction of travel along it.
5. **Row letters and column numbers** (A–D, 1–4): we add these in this guide so we can name tiles like **C2**. The real game doesn't show them.
6. **Timer** (bottom left): the countdown for this puzzle.
7. ⟳ **Rotate:** turns the selected tile 90°.
8. ⇄ **Swap:** exchanges the positions of two tiles.
9. ✓ **Check:** submits your route. A correct route shows **"Valid route – well done!"** with a Continue button.

Versions can differ

Some candidates describe tapping a tile to cycle its direction, while others see separate Rotate and Swap buttons. The thinking is identical: **find where the route breaks, then change that tile**. Read the on-screen instructions (and use the practice question, if one is offered) to confirm the controls.

THE BUILDING BLOCKS

03 Tiles, Arrows & the Connection Rule

Every tile is a piece of track joining **two sides** of its square. There are two basic shapes:

Straight tile
Joins opposite sides: **Left–Right** (horizontal) or **Up–Down** (vertical). The rocket goes straight through.

Corner (turn) tile
Joins two neighbouring sides, like **Left–Up** or **Down–Right**. The rocket turns 90°.

The connection rule

A route is valid only when every tile connects to the next

The side where the rocket **leaves** one tile must touch a side where the next tile **has track**. If a tile sends the rocket **right**, the tile on its right must have track on its **left** side. Any gap, wall or wrong-way piece breaks the route.

Rocket leaves a tile going…	…the next tile must have track on its
→ Right	**Left** side
← Left	**Right** side
↑ Up	**Bottom** side
↓ Down	**Top** side

YOUR TWO TOOLS

04 Rotate & Swap: How the Tools Work

⟳ Rotate: turns a tile 90° clockwise each time



Start
connects Left–Down

1 tap
connects Up–Left

2 taps
connects Right–Up

3 taps
connects Down–Right

One corner tile, rotated 0–3 times. Four taps bring it back to the start, so **never tap more than 3 times**.

Side now →	after 1 tap	after 2 taps	after 3 taps
Up	Right	Down	Left
Right	Down	Left	Up
Down	Left	Up	Right
Left	Up	Right	Down

Rotation can fix
A tile that is the **right shape** but faces the **wrong way**, for example a corner that turns down when you need it to turn up.

Rotation can't fix
A tile that is the **wrong shape**. No amount of rotating turns a straight into a corner. That's when you use **Swap**.

⇄ Swap: exchanges two tiles

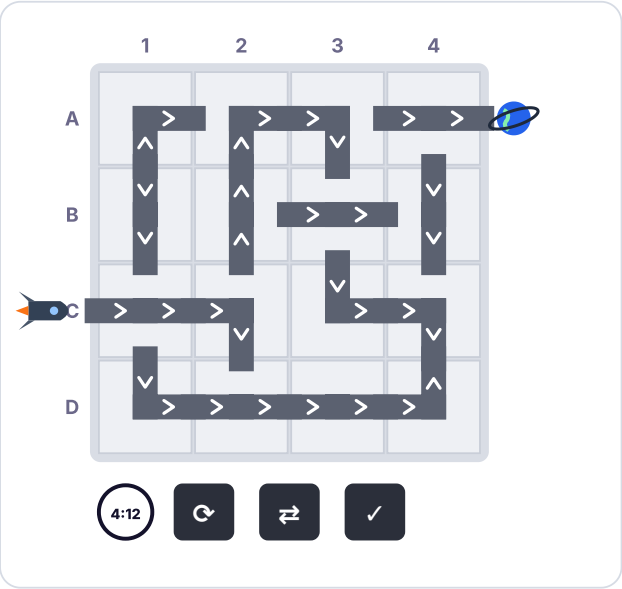
Select a tile on the route that has the wrong shape, and swap it with a tile of the **right shape** from somewhere the rocket never goes. Only swap with tiles that are **off the route**, or you'll break a part that already works.

05

SEE IT IN ACTION

Full Play-Through, Step by Step

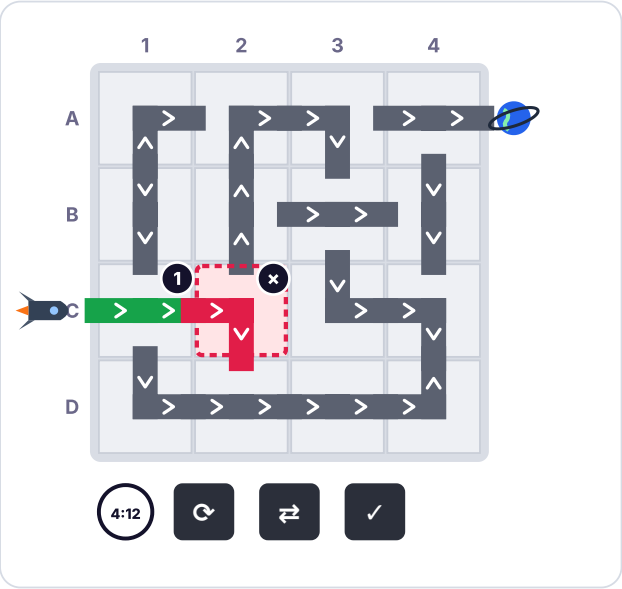
Here is one complete puzzle from start to finish. The rocket enters at **row C** on the left, and the planet is to the right of **A4**.



1 Study the grid before touching anything

Find the **start** (rocket, entering C1 from the left) and the **goal** (planet, right of A4).

Don't rotate anything yet. First understand where the rocket would go right now.

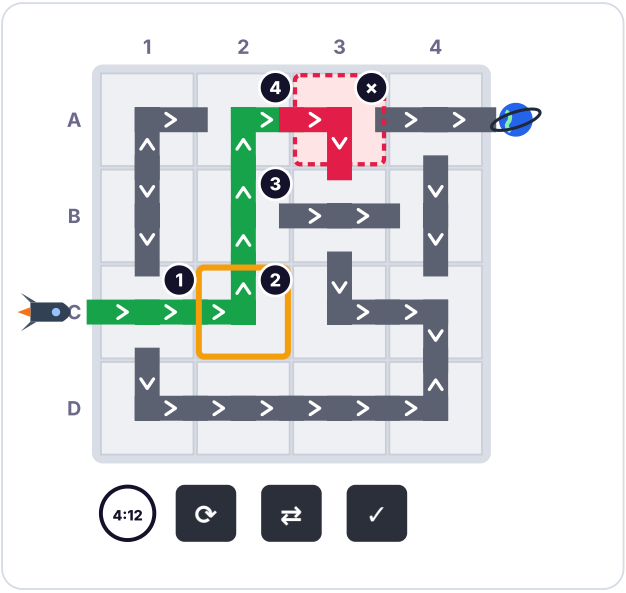


2 Trace the current route until it breaks

The rocket enters **C1** (straight, Left → Right) ✓ and moves into **C2**.

C2 is a corner that turns **down**, into D2. But D2 is a horizontal straight with no track on top, so the route **breaks at C2** ×.

We need C2 to turn **up** towards B2 instead.

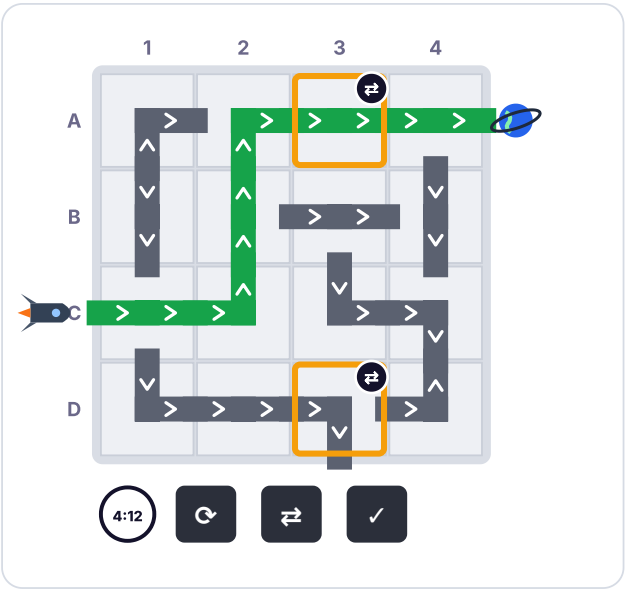


3 Fix the earliest break: rotate C2 once

C2 joins Left–Down. From the rotation table, 1 tap turns Left→Up and Down→Left, so it now joins **Left–Up** ✓.

Re-trace from the start: C1 → C2 → **B2** (vertical) → **A2** (corner, Down → Right) → **A3**...

A3 is a corner turning down into B3, which has no track on top. It's the **next break** ×.

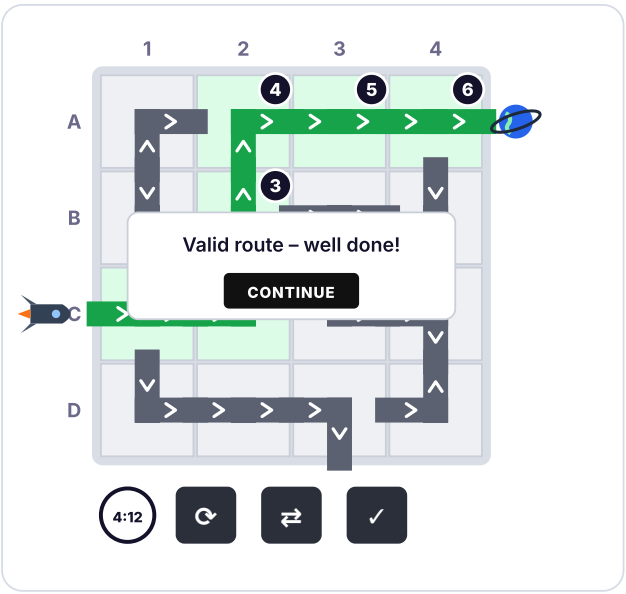


4 Wrong shape? Swap it

A3 needs to be a **horizontal straight** (Left → Right). It's a corner, and rotating a corner can never make a straight.

D3 is a horizontal straight that the rocket never uses, so **swap A3 ⇄ D3**.

Re-trace: C1 → C2 → B2 → A2 → A3 → A4 → planet ✓



5 Verify the whole route, then press ✓ Check

Trace one final time from the rocket to the planet, saying the moves to yourself: "*right, up, up, right, right, right*".

Only then press ✓ **Check**. You'll see **"Valid route – well done!"**, then press **Continue** for the next puzzle.

Total changes: 1 rotation + 1 swap. Most real puzzles need just 1–3 changes like this.

06

THE CORE TECHNIQUE

The 6-Step Solving Method

1

Study

Find the start, the goal and the overall layout. Don't change anything yet.

2

Trace

Follow the current route from the rocket, tile by tile, until it breaks, loops or leaves the grid.

3

Find the earliest break

The **first** tile where things go wrong is your first fix. Later tiles don't matter yet.

4

Fix with minimum changes

Right shape, wrong direction → **Rotate**. Wrong shape → **Swap** with an off-route tile.

5

Re-trace everything

After **every** change, trace again from the rocket. One early change affects everything after it.

6

Verify, then Check

Press ✓ only when the full route is traced to the planet. Don't submit on a guess.

07

THINK LIKE A TOP SCORER

Pro Strategies

🔁 Work backwards from the planet

Ask: "Which tile must deliver the rocket into the planet, and from which side?" Trace backwards a few tiles. Solving from **both ends** and meeting in the middle is often fastest on long routes.

🥇 Earliest wrong tile first

If the route breaks at tile 3 of 10, fix tile 3 first. The rocket never reaches tiles 4–10 on its current course, so they can't be judged yet.

🌀 Watch for loops

If your trace comes back to a tile it already visited (for example right → down → left → up), the rocket is in a loop. Break the loop by changing one tile in it so it heads towards the planet.

🗣️ Say the directions to yourself

"Right, right, up, up, right...". Saying each move catches tracing slips far better than silently scanning the grid.

🏷️ Name the tiles

Think in coordinates (C1 → C2 → B2...). It stops you losing your place, especially on bigger grids.

↩️ Reset is your friend

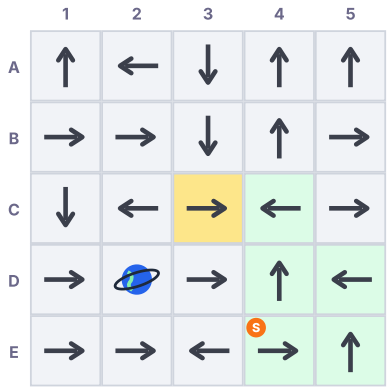
If you've made a mess, reset (if the version offers it) and re-trace calmly. Thirty seconds of re-checking beats losing the whole puzzle.

TRAIN THE CORE SKILL

08 Worked Example: Fix One Tile

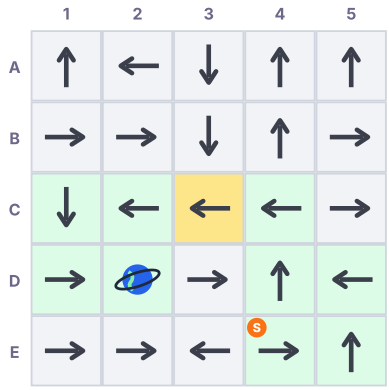
To practise **tracing** without the real app, we use simple **arrow grids**. Each tile has one arrow, and the rocket moves one tile in that direction. This is exactly the skill the real game tests: following a route without losing track, and spotting the first wrong tile.

Before: the route fails



Start **E4**, planet **D2**. Trace: `E4 → E5 → D5 → D4 → C4 → C3 → C4`. The rocket **gets stuck in a loop**. The yellow tile is where it first goes wrong.

After: one tile changed



Change **C3** from → to ←. New route: `E4 → E5 → D5 → D4 → C4 → C3 → C2 → C1 → D1 → D2` → planet ✓

How we found it

1. We traced from S and marked every tile visited (green).
2. We also traced **backwards** from the planet: which tiles already have arrows flowing into it? That shows us the "good" part of the grid we need to reach.
3. We found the **first** tile on the rocket's route where pointing a different way joins that good part, then changed it and re-traced the **whole** route to confirm.

BEAT THE CLOCK

09 Time Plan & Common Mistakes

Study · 1 min	Trace & plan · 1.5 min	Apply · 1 min	Verify · 30s	Buffer

A rough plan for a puzzle of about 4–5 minutes. Keep an eye on the timer, and don't spend 4 minutes on the first break.

Mistake ×	Fix ✓
Rotating tiles randomly before understanding the route	Study and trace first. Change only tiles you've identified.
Fixing a later break before an earlier one	Always fix in the order the rocket meets them.
Not re-tracing after each change	Re-trace from the rocket after **every** rotate or swap.
Rotating a tile 4+ times	4 rotations = no change. Use the rotation table: you need at most 3.
Trying to rotate a straight into a corner	Wrong shape means swap it with an off-route tile of the right shape.
Swapping away a tile the route already uses	Only swap with tiles the rocket never touches.

Mistake ×	Fix ✓
Missing a loop	If you revisit a tile while tracing, it's a loop. Change one tile inside it.
Pressing ✓ on a guess	You have time. Verify the full route first.

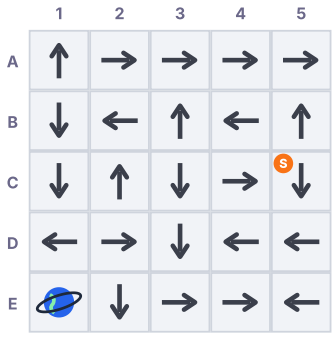
TEST YOURSELF

10 Practice: 12 Puzzles

Set A · Trace the rocket (6 puzzles)

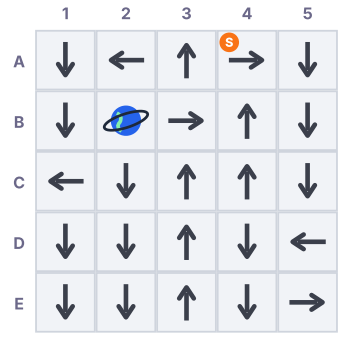
The rocket starts on the orange **S** tile and moves one tile at a time in the direction of each arrow. Write down the full route using cell names (for example C2 → C3 → B3). Does it **reach the planet**, **leave the grid** or get stuck in a **loop**?

A1



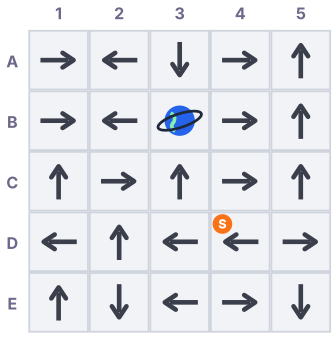
Start: **C5** · Planet: **E1**

A2



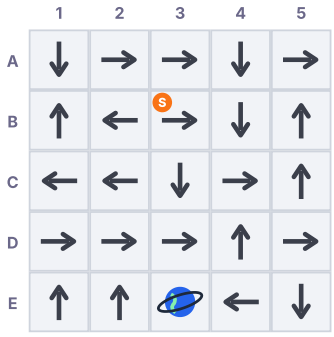
Start: **A4** · Planet: **B2**

A3



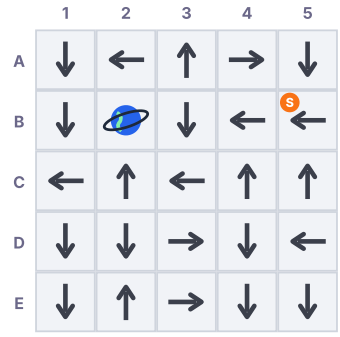
Start: **D4** · Planet: **B3**

A4



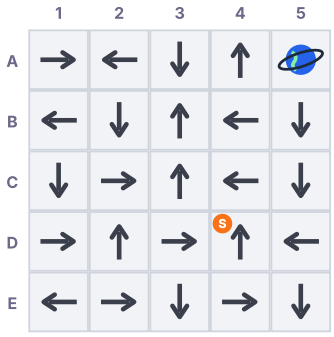
Start: **B3** · Planet: **E3**

A5



Start: **B5** · Planet: **B2**

A6

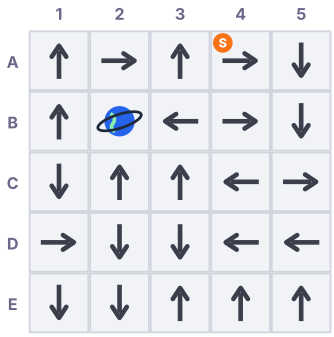


Start: **D4** · Planet: **A5**

Set B · Fix one tile (6 puzzles)

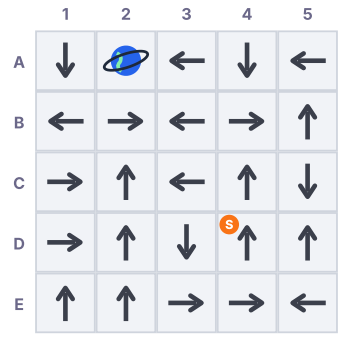
Exactly **one** tile is pointing the wrong way. Find it and say which direction it should point so the rocket reaches the planet. This is the core skill of the real game.

B1



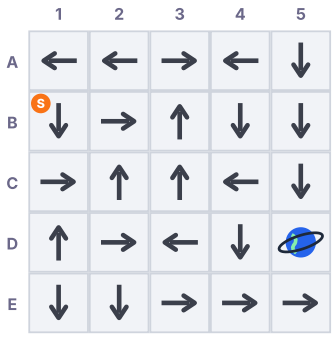
Start: **A4** · Planet: **B2**

B2



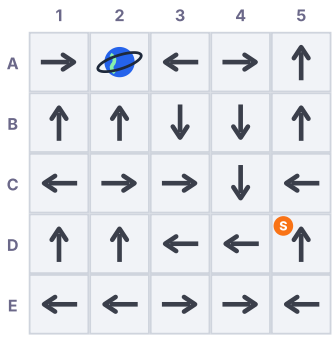
Start: **D4** · Planet: **A2**

B3



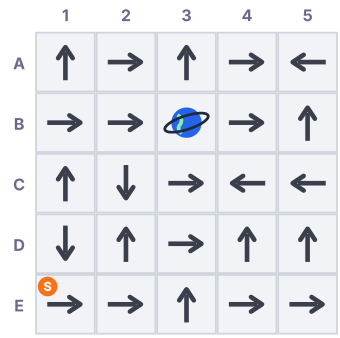
Start: **B1** · Planet: **D5**

B4



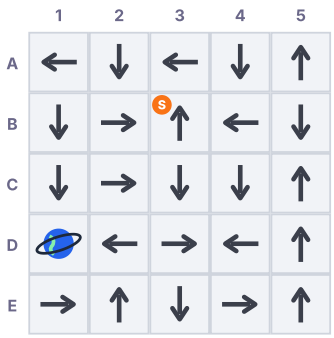
Start: **D5** · Planet: **A2**

B5



Start: **E1** · Planet: **B3**

B6



Start: **B3** · Planet: **D1**

How to practise

Give yourself **2 minutes per puzzle**. Write the route as coordinates (C2 → C3 → B3…) rather than just eyeballing it. This disciplined habit prevents tracing errors under real exam pressure.

CHECK YOUR ANSWERS

11 Answer Key

Every route below was traced and verified by computer. In Set B, the listed fix is the **only** single-tile change that works.

Set A: answers

#	Route	Result
A1	C5 → D5 → D4 → D3 → E3 → E4 → E5 → E4	Loop returns to E4
A2	A4 → A5 → B5 → C5 → D5 → D4 → E4	Leaves the grid from E4 going ↓
A3	D4 → D3 → D2 → C2 → C3 → B3	Reaches the planet ✓
A4	B3 → B4 → C4 → C5 → B5 → A5	Leaves the grid from A5 going →
A5	B5 → B4 → B3 → C3 → C2 → B2	Reaches the planet ✓
A6	D4 → C4 → C3 → B3 → A3 → B3	Loop returns to B3

Set B: answers

#	Wrong tile → fix	Corrected route
B1	**C5**: → → ←	A4 → A5 → B5 → C5 → C4 → C3 → B3 → B2
B2	**A4**: ↓ → ←	D4 → C4 → B4 → B5 → A5 → A4 → A3 → A2
B3	**A4**: ← → →	B1 → C1 → C2 → B2 → B3 → A3 → A4 → A5 → B5 → C5 → D5
B4	**C2**: → → ↑	D5 → C5 → C4 → D4 → D3 → D2 → C2 → B2 → A2
B5	**C3**: → → ↑	E1 → E2 → E3 → D3 → D4 → C4 → C3 → B3
B6	**B2**: → → ←	B3 → A3 → A2 → B2 → B1 → C1 → D1

Scoring: 11–12 correct means test-ready. 8–10 means good, so re-trace the ones you missed. Below 8, re-read Sections 5–7 and try again tomorrow.

12

GET TEST-READY

7-Day Plan & Test-Day Checklist

Day	Focus	What to do (about 30 minutes)
Day 1	Understand the game	Read Sections 1–4. Learn the connection rule and the rotation table by heart.
Day 2	Play-through	Study Section 5. Redraw its grid on paper and solve it yourself without looking.
Day 3	Tracing	Do Set A (trace puzzles). Write every route as coordinates.
Day 4	Fixing	Do Set B (fix one tile). For each one, name the earliest wrong tile before you look for the fix.
Day 5	Speed	Redo Sets A and B with a 90-second limit per puzzle.
Day 6	Simulation	Use the live practice tool (or draw your own grids) for full-timed 3-puzzle rounds.
Day 7	Revise	Re-read Sections 6, 7 and 9. Rest well.

Test-Day Checklist

- ✔ Read the instructions and confirm how Rotate and Swap work
- ✔ Find the rocket (start) and planet (goal) first
- ✔ Trace the current route before changing anything
- ✔ Fix the earliest break first

- ✔ Right shape but wrong way → Rotate (max 3 taps)
- ✔ Wrong shape → Swap with an off-route tile
- ✔ Re-trace the full route after every change
- ✔ Press ✓ only after a complete, verified trace

Remember

This game rewards **patience and system**, not speed. Trace, find the earliest break, make the smallest fix, and re-trace. Do that calmly on every puzzle and you'll clear Game 2.

Disclaimer: This is an independent preparation guide for informational purposes only. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or an official document of Accenture. The game description is based on candidate experiences and screenshots, and the real game may differ. All illustrations are original drawings, and practice puzzles are original. Always check the latest details on the official Accenture careers portal.